The testimony to Ratan's leadership, if any were required, was wholesomely provided by the last AGM of the company that he addressed. At the meeting, he took leave of the shareholders, saying, 'I will carry the warmth and affection of not only the employees but also the shareholders for [the] rest of my life. You have been very emotional. It has been an equally emotional meeting for me. I am also too emotional today … I am an emotional person.'

Sreenath Kapur, a shareholder who had been associated with the company since it was called Tata-Finlay, said, 'I have seen B.K. Dutta when he managed operations at Tata-Finlay long back. I had numerous interactions and arguments as a shareholder with Darbari Seth, who actually transformed Tata Tea in the 1980s. But never have I seen a chairman in any Indian company as Ratan Tata.'